THE CURLY CHEF

Eggless Gourmet Chocolate Chunk Cookie Pie

A bakery-style cookie baked as a thick pie: golden edges, a soft chewy centre and generous dark-and-milk-chocolate pockets.

Yield	Tin	Oven	Bake time
1 pie, 6–8 slices	15 cm / 6-inch round metal tin	175°C conventional	25–32 minutes

Recipe goal

This is a thick cookie baked in a pie tin—not a cake and not a pastry-crust pie. The edges should be golden and set while the centre remains soft and chewy after resting. Regular softened butter is used; do not brown or melt it.

Foolproof key: Weigh ingredients accurately, use the specified 15 cm metal tin, chill the shaped dough and judge doneness by the edges and centre—not time alone.

1. Ingredients

Weigh all ingredients before mixing. Chop the chocolate into irregular pieces for attractive pockets.

Ingredient	Exact amount	Notes
Unsalted butter	100 g	Softened to room temperature; not melted
Light brown sugar	90 g	Adds moisture and caramel-like flavour
Caster sugar	35 g	Helps the edges brown
Full-fat milk	35 g	Eggless moisture and binding
Vanilla extract	5 g	Culinary vanilla
Plain flour / maida	170 g	Weigh; do not scoop by volume
Cornflour / cornstarch	10 g	Helps tenderise the crumb
Baking soda	2 g	Weigh accurately
Fine salt	2 g	Balances sweetness
Dark couverture chocolate, chopped	120 g	Around 55–70% cocoa
Milk chocolate, chopped	40 g	Adds creamy chocolate notes

Equipment

Digital scale; 15 cm / 6-inch round metal cake or pie tin; baking parchment; two mixing bowls; sturdy spatula; whisk; knife and chopping board; oven; wire cooling rack. A hand whisk is enough—no stand mixer needed.

2. Before you begin

• **Prepare the tin:** Line the base of a 15 cm round metal tin with parchment. Lightly line the sides if convenient. Avoid a silicone mould.

• **Preheat:** Heat a conventional oven to 175°C and position a rack in the middle. For a fan oven, start around 160°C and check early.

• **Butter:** Let butter soften until pliable and able to hold its shape. It should not look oily or liquid.

• **Chocolate:** Chop into irregular chunks. Any pieces reserved for the top must come from the listed 120 g dark and 40 g milk chocolate, not extra chocolate.

3. Detailed method

Step 1 — Cream butter and sugars (about 2 minutes)

Place 100 g softened butter in a bowl. Add 90 g light brown sugar and 35 g caster sugar. Press and mix with a sturdy spatula or hand whisk for about 2 minutes, scraping the sides. Aim for a cohesive creamy paste with some sugar texture; it need not be whipped like cake batter. Do not melt the butter.

Step 2 — Add milk and vanilla

Measure 35 g full-fat milk and 5 g vanilla. Add to the butter-sugar mixture and stir until reasonably combined. It may look slightly separated at first; keep stirring and scrape the bowl. Do not add eggs.

Step 3 — Mix the dry ingredients

In a second bowl, whisk together 170 g plain flour, 10 g cornflour, 2 g baking soda and 2 g fine salt for 20–30 seconds, dispersing the soda and salt evenly.

Step 4 — Make the dough

Add the dry mixture to the wet mixture. Fold with a spatula until the flour is nearly incorporated. Avoid vigorous or prolonged mixing. Stop when no dry flour remains.

Step 5 — Fold in chocolate

Add 120 g chopped dark couverture chocolate and 40 g chopped milk chocolate. Fold only until distributed. The dough should be thick and scoopable with visible chunks. If the room is warm and the dough is unusually soft, refrigerate for 10–15 minutes before shaping; do not add extra flour.

Step 6 — Shape

Transfer the entire dough into the prepared 15 cm tin. Press evenly into the corners to make one thick round slab. Smooth the top lightly without compressing excessively. Press a few reserved chunks from the measured chocolate into the surface.

Step 7 — Chill

Refrigerate the shaped dough for 30–45 minutes. This firms the butter and helps the pie hold its shape. Keep the tin level and protect the dough from fridge odours.

Step 8 — Bake

Bake on the middle rack at 175°C in a conventional oven for approximately 25–32 minutes. Start checking at 24–25 minutes because ovens and tins vary. The rim should be golden and set; the centre may look soft but must not be wet liquid batter. If the top browns too quickly, loosely shield with foil near the end.

Step 9 — Rest and cool

Set the tin on a wire rack. Leave the pie in the tin for at least 30–45 minutes; residual heat continues to set the centre. For neat slices, cool longer before removing. Rewarm individual slices gently for a warm dessert.

Step 10 — Slice and serve

Run a thin knife around the edge if needed. Lift the pie out carefully and cut with a sharp knife using a firm downward motion. Wipe the blade between cuts. Serve plain or with vanilla ice cream and a tiny pinch of flaky salt.

4. Signs of success

Feature	Correct result	Warning sign
Edges	Golden, set and lightly crisp	Pale and fragile, or very dark and hard
Centre	Soft and chewy after resting	Wet liquid batter or completely dry and hard
Crumb	Dense cookie texture with chocolate pockets	Cake-like, floury or crumbly
Shape	One thick, round cookie pie	Thin, spread-out cookie or uneven thickness
Chocolate	Visible irregular chunks	Chocolate entirely lost into a smear

5. Troubleshooting

Greasy or spreading too much: Butter may be too warm or dough insufficiently chilled. Use soft but opaque butter and chill 30–45 minutes.

Dry or crumbly dough: Check weighing accuracy and ensure the full 35 g milk is included. Do not add extra flour.

Hard centre: Likely overbaked. Start checking at 24–25 minutes; the centre continues setting while cooling.

Centre seems raw: Bake in 2–3 minute increments and check that the centre is no longer wet batter. Your oven may run cool.

Breaks when sliced: It was probably cut too hot. Rest at least 30–45 minutes, longer for cleaner slices.

Chocolate browns too much: Press exposed chunks partly into the dough or loosely shield the top with foil near the end.

6. Storage and serving

Cool completely before storing airtight. As a conservative home-quality guide, keep in a cool room for up to 2 days or refrigerate for about 4–5 days; refrigeration firms the texture, so warm slices gently before serving. Freeze well-wrapped portions for longer storage and thaw before reheating. These are quality guidelines, not validated commercial shelf-life claims.

For a restaurant-style finish, serve a warm slice with a small scoop of vanilla ice cream and a tiny pinch of flaky salt. Keep the garnish restrained so the cookie pie remains the hero.

7. Final baker’s checklist

■ Butter softened, not melted.

■ Ingredients weighed accurately.

■ Dough mixed only until combined.

■ 15 cm metal tin prepared with parchment.

■ Shaped dough chilled for 30–45 minutes.

■ Oven fully preheated to 175°C conventional.

■ Edges golden and set; centre slightly soft.

■ Pie rested at least 30–45 minutes before slicing.

THE CURLY CHEF • Eggless baking, crafted with precision